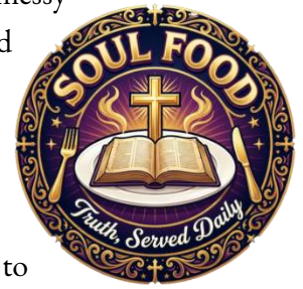


Introduction – The Art of Through

“The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want.” — Psalm 23:1 (KJV)

Many times in life, we feel stuck. It might be at the starting line, or right in the messy middle. At times, it feels like our feet are chained to invisible blocks buried deep in the ground. No matter how much we want to move forward, something holds us in place.



This month’s lessons are designed to walk us through stories of people who faced real adversity—but didn’t give up. From Joseph in the pit, to Hannah in her barrenness, to Abram caught between promise and fulfillment, to those who pushed through crowds and pain for a touch from Jesus—each one shows us the **art of through**.

You don’t need to be a pro, a priest, or a “seasoned saint” to make it through hard seasons. You just need determination, honest faith, and a willingness to keep walking with God when giving up would be easier.

Everyone has a story. Many stories are similar, but your journey still feels uniquely your own. Psalm 23, written by David, reflects the heart of someone who knew rejection, doubt, and danger—yet kept following the Shepherd. Victory didn’t come by going *around* the valley, but by walking *through* it with God.

This segment of study explores biblical figures who endured trials and still pressed through. Their stories remind us that in God, we win not by skipping the struggle, but by trusting the Shepherd to lead us through to the other side.



SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY (AE)



Breakfast Edition Month 2: Lesson 1 – Joseph

The Young Dreamer



Theme: The Art of Through



Background Text: Genesis 37; 39; 41–42



Key Verse: Genesis 42:6 (WEB)

“Joseph’s brothers came, and bowed themselves down to him with their faces to the earth.”



Appetizer – The Dream That Started It All, Gen 37:5–8

⁵Joseph dreamed a dream, and he told it to his brothers, and they hated him all the more. ⁶He said to them, ‘Please hear this dream which I have dreamed: ⁷for behold, we were binding sheaves in the field, and behold, my sheaf arose and also stood upright; and behold, your sheaves came around, and bowed down to my sheaf.’

⁸His brothers said to him, ‘Will you indeed reign over us? Or will you indeed have dominion over us?’ They hated him all the more for his dreams and for his words.”

Joseph saw a glimpse of his future long before anyone else believed it. What God showed him made his brothers jealous and angry, but their feeling didn’t invalidate the fact that dream still came from God.

□ CST – Called Before You’re Ready

God can give us glimpses of our destiny before others are ready to believe it—or before *we* fully understand it. Favor can feel lonely when the people closest to you don’t see what God has spoken over your life.

Reflection:

How do you stay humble when God’s favor on your life creates tension with others?

Main Course

Bite 1 — Betrayed but Chosen, Gen 37:18–19, 22a, 28

¹⁸They saw him afar off, and before he came near to them, they conspired against him to kill him. ¹⁹They said to one another, “Behold, this dreamer comes. ²²Reuben said to them, “Shed no blood. Throw him into this pit that is in the wilderness, but lay no hand on him”

²⁸Midianites who were merchants passed by, and they drew and lifted up Joseph out of the pit, and sold Joseph to the Ishmaelites for twenty pieces of silver. They brought Joseph into Egypt.

The very people who should have protected Joseph became the ones who betrayed him—but their evil could not cancel God’s plan.

CST – When Betrayal Becomes a Bridge

Sometimes betrayal doesn’t block your destiny—it *pushes* you toward it. The pit felt like punishment, but it was really a passageway. What others meant for harm, God was already folding into His larger story of rescue and preservation.

Reflection:

Think of a time when someone’s betrayal or rejection pushed you into a new chapter. How might God have been redirecting you?

Bite 2 — Integrity in the Dark, Gen 39:7–8,17, 20

⁷After these things, his master’s wife set her eyes on Joseph; and she said, ‘Lie with me.’ ⁸But he refused, and said... ‘How then can I do this great wickedness, and sin against God?’ ¹⁷She spoke to him according to these words, saying, “The Hebrew servant, whom you have brought to us, came in to me to mock me, ²⁰Joseph’s master took him, and put him into the prison, the place where the king’s prisoners were bound, and he was there in custody.

Joseph guarded his character even when no one from home was watching and when compromise might have seemed to make his life easier. His integrity and personal conviction mattered more in the moment than the temptation to be agreeable..

CST – Holiness When No One’s Looking

Holiness means running away from what others explain away. Joseph understood that sin isn’t just breaking rules—it’s breaking God’s heart. He chose obedience over opportunity, even though it cost him his reputation and his freedom.

Reflection:

What guardrails (boundaries, habits, or people) help protect your integrity when temptation keeps coming “day after day”?

Bite 3 — From Prison to Palace, Gen 41:15-16, 37-39

¹⁵ Pharaoh said to Joseph, “I have dreamed a dream, and there is no one who can interpret it. I have heard it said of you, that when you hear a dream you can interpret it.”¹⁶ Joseph answered Pharaoh, saying, ‘It isn’t in me. God will give Pharaoh an answer of peace.’

³⁷ The thing was good in the eyes of Pharaoh, and in the eyes of all his servants. ³⁸ Pharaoh said to his servants, “Can we find such a one as this, a man in whom is the Spirit of God?” ³⁹ Pharaoh said to Joseph, “Because God has shown you all of this, there is no one so discreet and wise as you.

In one day, Joseph went from prisoner to prime minister—but he made sure the glory went to God, not himself. God was preparing Joseph in places people forgot about: the pit and the prison. Those “wasted years” became his training ground in leadership, humility, and dependence on God. When the door finally opened, Joseph was ready—not because he was perfect, but because he stayed faithful.

Reflection:

Where do you feel “hidden” or overlooked right now? How might God be quietly preparing you for your next assignment?

Dessert — Faith Rewarded, Gen 42:5-6

⁵ The sons of Israel came to buy among those who came, for the famine was in the land of Canaan. ⁶ Joseph was the governor over the land. It was he who sold to all the people of the land. Joseph’s brothers came, and bowed themselves down to him with their faces to the earth.

The vision came to pass. His brothers did in fact bow before him, as he served in a position of authority just below Pharaoh. Even though they thought it would be a bad thing, Jehovah Jireh – the God who supplies, used their younger brother to prevent their starvation and preserve their survival! Their rejection of him propelled him into the position of savior for a region.

To-Go Box

- The **pit**, the **prison**, and the **palace** were all part of Joseph’s training, not random pain.
- Betrayal couldn’t block God’s plan; it became the bridge God used to move Joseph into position.
- Integrity in hidden places prepared Joseph to carry influence in public places.
- God’s promotion often comes suddenly, but the preparation is usually slow and silent.
- What God speaks in a dream, He will fulfill in His time—our job is to stay faithful “through,” not just shout about the promise at the start.

Closing Prayer

“Lord God, thank You for the story of Joseph and for reminding us that You are working even when life feels unfair. Help us to trust You in the pit, to walk in integrity when no one is watching, and to stay faithful in seasons where we feel forgotten. Strengthen our faith to believe that Your promises will come to pass in Your perfect timing. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Reflection Questions

1. Where do you see yourself in Joseph’s journey right now—pit, prison, palace, or somewhere in between?

2. Write down one promise, dream, or calling from God that you refuse to give up on, even if it seems delayed.

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Joseph’s brothers sold him for _____ pieces of silver.
2. Joseph resisted the temptation of _____.
3. Pharaoh said Joseph was filled with the _____ of God.
4. Joseph’s brothers bowed before him in _____.

(Check the Appendix for answers)

 Notes Page — Group Discussion & Personal Study

Appendix – Breakfast Month 2 (AE) Answer Key

Theme: The Art of Through – Youth Edition

Lesson 1 – Joseph: The Young Dreamer

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Joseph's brothers sold him for _____ pieces of silver.
2. Joseph resisted the temptation of _____.
3. Pharaoh said Joseph was filled with the _____ of God.
4. Joseph's brothers bowed before him in _____.

Answer Key:

1. **Twenty (20)**
2. **Potiphar's wife**
3. The **Spirit** of God
4. **Egypt**

Lesson 2 – Hannah: Barren but Not Lifeless

Activity – Word Scramble: Hannah's Hope

1. NNAHHA → **HANNAH**
2. ULSAME → **SAMUEL**
3. YERARP → **PRAYER**
4. THEFAI → **FAITH**

5. LIHEFSI → **HIS LIFE**